

offers a higher level of security for enterprises. Solutions like LucidLink Wireless security delivers enterprise level security with the consumer-level simplicity that can be easily and quickly deployed in home offices, small offices, and medium businesses.

WPA-PSK (Pre-Shared Key): WPA-PSK provides a relatively secure solution for consumer networks. If you're technically competent, and feel comfortable configuring the security parameters of your wireless access point or router, you can configure your wireless network to support WPA-PSK. By entering a common 64 digit hexadecimal key into every device on the network you can properly encrypt all network traffic to and from the access point.

WPA-PSK has fixed many of the problems associated with pre-shared keys used in WEP. While it is quite awkward to properly enter a 64 digit hexadecimal key into each device on the network, if done carefully, it can provide strong encryption of network traffic and ward off hackers.

One of the common complaints with WPA-PSK, however, is that it uses a common key across all of the devices and PCs on the network. If you, an employee, or your child innocently shares this key with anyone, the integrity of the network can be compromised. If any person leaves an organization or needs to be denied access to the network, every PC on the network needs to be reprogrammed with a new 64 digit pre-shared key. The need to re-key every device on the network if a single user is removed can become a heavy burden to maintaining a small business network.

WPA-Enterprise uses the same type of network security used by enterprises and ISP over the last decade to protect access to wired networks. Unlike WPA-PSK, each user accessing the network is given unique credentials. These credentials may be in the form of passwords, electronic certificates, or in the case of LucidLink, automatically configured security credentials.